PATRICK CLEBURNE
TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: “AT ALL HAZARDS” (vidIQ, made in one go: the hook battlefield + a colour portrait; vidIQ score 92; variant B “HOLD THE GAP” scored 95)

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Cleburne-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 636 MB)
Download	(Gofile link: see chat)
Length	14:52
Voice	Voice A: Kokoro am_michael converted to the owner's voice (reference: the approved voice-A sample)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit sounds, original effects
Flags	Owner's pick A1: US 35-star flag + Confederate First National ('Stars and Bars'); never the battle flag

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: The Man Who Saved the Confederacy's Western Army
2:27	Move 1: Tunnel Hill (25 Nov 1863)
6:13	Move 2: Ringgold Gap (27 Nov 1863)
9:54	Move 3: Pickett's Mill (27 May 1864)
13:41	Legacy

Key frames: the hook (0:00-1:22)



2. Title and thumbnail

Title (recommended; vidIQ title score 87)

Patrick Cleburne's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Saved the Confederacy's Western Army

Alternatives:

- Patrick Cleburne's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Stopped Sherman (vidIQ 87)
- Patrick Cleburne's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Beat Sherman (vidIQ 86)
- Patrick Cleburne's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Saved an Army (vidIQ 85)

Thumbnail banner texts

A: AT ALL HAZARDS: the words of Bragg's order to Cleburne at Ringgold Gap (stakes, 3 words, no context needed; TG type 3). **B: HOLD THE GAP**: his decision in plain words (TG type 1). Studio Test & compare can run both.



Both thumbnails were generated by vidIQ in one go (owner rule 2026-10-26), with 3 Tactical Genius thumbnails as references; A scores 92 and B 95 on vidIQ. The battlefield is the hook (Union columns marching on Ringgold Gap, hidden Confederate units on the ridge walls, fire in the gap). The portrait is an AI-generated Civil War general in colour, not a photograph of Cleburne. The AI's garbled map labels were repainted by hand (tools/make_thumb_labels.py); no battle flags.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound and image licences require them.

```
Patrick Cleburne's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Saved the Confederacy's Western Army

In November 1863, the Confederacy's western army was running for its life. Its last hope was a
mountain gap called Ringgold. Four thousand men held it against three times their number, and saved
the army.

In this video we break down Patrick Cleburne's three greatest tactical moves: Tunnel Hill at
Missionary Ridge on 25 November 1863, where one division on the high ground broke Sherman's attacks
one brigade at a time and counterattacked; the rear guard at Ringgold Gap two days later, with two
guns hidden behind cut brush and a reserve that outran the Union flankers up Taylor's Ridge; and
Pickett's Mill on 27 May 1864, where a Union flank march walked into a steep ravine. We also cover
his Dalton memorandum of January 1864, which proposed freeing and arming enslaved men to save the
Confederacy, and what it cost him.

Let them tire on the hill, then strike. Hide your strength until they are close. Let the ground do
the killing.

Which was his greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? Tell us in the comments, and tell us which commander we
should cover next.

CHAPTERS
0:00 Intro: The Man Who Saved the Confederacy's Western Army
1:03 Who Was Patrick Cleburne?
1:45 The Siege of Chattanooga Breaks
2:27 Move 1: Tunnel Hill (25 Nov 1863)
4:06 One Brigade at a Time
4:50 The Counterattack
6:13 Move 2: Ringgold Gap (27 Nov 1863)
7:19 What Would You Do?
7:41 The Hidden Guns
8:30 The Climb Up Taylor's Ridge
9:54 Move 3: Pickett's Mill (27 May 1864)
10:36 Howard's Flank March
11:21 Into the Ravine
12:25 Three Brigades, One Ravine
13:41 Legacy

SOURCES
The War of the Rebellion: Official Records of the Union and Confederate Armies, Series I, vols. 31,
38 and 52
Craig L. Symonds, Stonewall of the West: Patrick Cleburne and the Civil War (University Press of
Kansas, 1997)
Peter Cozzens, The Shipwreck of Their Hopes: The Battles for Chattanooga (University of Illinois
Press, 1994)
Albert Castel, Decision in the West: The Atlanta Campaign of 1864 (University Press of Kansas, 1992)
Ambrose Bierce, The Crime at Pickett's Mill
National Park Service: The Battles for Chattanooga (Civil War Series)
American Battlefield Trust and Battle of Franklin Trust battle pages; Emerging Civil War

CREDITS
Maps: original animations. Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data). Rivers traced from the
elevation data. Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots"
by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by
Kostrava (CC0), via freesound.org. Transition sounds: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects Free License).
Other sound effects: original.

Images: Library of Congress (no known restrictions; photographs by Mathew Brady's studio and
others); Ambrose Bierce portrait from Wikimedia Commons (public domain). Flags: drawn from the
public-domain designs.

Narration voice: AI-generated. Maps: original animations.
■ Business enquiries: [email to fill in]
#Cleburne #CivilWar #MilitaryHistory
```

4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, civil war documentary, Patrick Cleburne, Patrick Ronayne Cleburne, Stonewall of the West, Battle of Ringgold Gap, Missionary Ridge, Tunnel Hill, Pickett's Mill, Chattanooga campaign, Atlanta Campaign, Army of Tennessee, Confederate generals, William T. Sherman, animated battle map, greatest military tactics, american civil war animated history
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Cleburne = KLEE-burn, Chickamauga, Ringgold, Osterhaus, Granbury, Govan, Knefler, Goldthwaite, Bierce, Matthies, Raum, Hardee, Lowrey, Hazen)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which was Cleburne's greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? And which commander should we cover next?
End screen	One related video (e.g. the Sherman or George Thomas video) + subscribe, over the last ~20 s
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload thumbnail A (1280x720).
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen (one related video + subscribe) and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention; if CTR is under 2% after ~1,000 impressions, switch to the alternative thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing (research/FACT_NOTES.md; the Official Records and the Symonds/Cozzens/Castel books were not reachable, so these rest on secondary sources):
• Union strength at Ringgold Gap is hedged (“more than ten thousand”; sources say 12,000-16,000); Cleburne ~4,000 (OR figure 4,157 not confirmed).
• Tunnel Hill: Sherman ~16,000 in three divisions (the research's 25,000 was wrong); Union loss “almost 2,000”; Cleburne “a little over 200” (222 in the report: confirm). Brigade names Cumming and Brown (Hardee's reinforcements) are from memory.
• Ringgold Gap: Cleburne 20 killed, 190 wounded, 11 missing; Union “about 500” (509 in Wikipedia; Hooker's own return varies). Creighton and Crane killed: Geary's report to confirm.
• Bragg's resignation within days of Ringgold; Helena druggist/lawyer; Hooker's column delayed by a burned bridge: from memory.
• Pickett's Mill: Wood's division 1,457 and about 1,600 in all; Cleburne about 450 (his report). The positions in the ravine are approximate (no battle map could be downloaded). Matthies was WOUNDED (head), not killed: fixed in the script.
• Dalton memorandum, 2 Jan 1864: only the verified half of the 'loss of independence' line is quoted; Davis ordered it suppressed. Not used because unsourced: 'Follow me, boys', Lee's 'meteor' quote, 'Dead Angle' at

Pickett's Mill, 8 flags/500 prisoners, rolled shells.
• Bierce's only available photo is post-war (captioned 'later in life'); Granbury and Walker have initials badges (no public-domain photo).